

GIBSON CUSTOM SHOP • MADE-2-MEASURE

Les Paul Custom Figured

"Dark Blue Widow Burst" — 2024

SERIAL	DESIGN	CONDITION	INCLUDES
CS 403228	Nashville Custom Shop	Near-Mint / Complete	OHSC • COA • Tags

NEW / STREET	REVERB — RECENT SOLD	PRIVATE / LOCAL SALE	SHOP / DEALER OFFER
\$6,999–7,099	\$7,199	\$4,800–5,500	\$3,800–4,800
Current dealer retail for this run	'24 sibling, mint, sold via dealer	Denver marketplace, realistic net	Cash, more in trade / store credit

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01 What it is

MODEL	Gibson Custom Shop Les Paul Custom Figured — "Dark Blue Widow Burst"
YEAR	2024 (decoded from serial)
SERIAL	CS 403228 = CS (Custom Shop) + 4 (2024) + 03228 (build no.)
BUILD TYPE	Made-2-Measure / dealer-exclusive limited run — not a catalog production model
FAMILY	"Widow" series — defined by colour-matched binding & coloured split-diamond headstock inlay



PLATE 04 — FULL FACE, AAA FIGURED MAPLE TOP, BLUE-MATCHED 7-PLY BINDING, GOLD HARDWARE.

The certificate, the 'Gibson Custom' stamp on the back of the headstock, and the oval 'Gibson Custom' plate on the rear of the body confirm this is a genuine Nashville Custom Shop instrument — a meaningfully higher tier than a regular Gibson USA Les Paul Custom. The serial decodes cleanly on the modern Custom Shop pattern (CS + year-digit + build number), placing the build in 2024.

The "Widow" tag is the key to the finish. What separates a Blue Widow from an ordinary blue Les Paul Custom is the colour-matched treatment: the blue-tinted split-diamond headstock inlay, blue binding wrapping the body, neck and headstock, and the trans-blue burst over a hand-picked figured maple cap. Gibson has run the Widow theme in blue, red, purple, orange and green over the years — all low-volume Custom Shop pieces sold through select dealers, which is why you rarely see them on a big-box wall.

02 The evidence

PLATE 01 • TOP
Carved face — flame figure, gold covered humbuckers, gold TOM & stopbar, Rhythmic/Treble poker chip.

PLATE 02 • HEADSTOCK
Blue split-diamond inlay, gold Grover Kidney tuners, "Les Paul Custom" rod cover.

PLATE 03 • FINGERBOARD
Ebony board with pearl block inlays, multi-ply binding — full Custom appointments.

PLATE 04 • FULL FRONT
Single-cut LP Custom silhouette, blue-matched binding head to tail.

PLATE 05 • NECK REAR
Gloss blue neck, "Gibson Custom" headstock stamp — inspect here for repairs.

PLATE 06 • BODY REAR
Oval "Gibson Custom" plate & control cavity cover — check for buckle rash.

PLATE 07 • IN CASE
Original brown/gold-plush Custom hardshell case — present & correct.

PLATE 08 • PAPERS
Gibson Custom Certificate of Authenticity — "Les Paul Custom", CS403228.

BODY	Mahogany back, 2-pc hand-picked AAA figured maple top	PICKUPS ▶	490R / 498T humbuckers, gold covers (confirm — some runs shipped Custombuckers or EMG)
FINISH	Dark Blue Widow Burst, gloss nitro; blue-matched multi-ply binding	HARDWARE	Gold — TOM bridge, stopbar, Grover Kidney tuners, brass strap buttons
NECK	Mahogany, Custom long neck tenon	ELECTRONICS	2 vol / 2 tone, CTS POTS, 3-way toggle, cream switch tip
FINGERBOARD	Ebony, pearl block inlays, split-diamond headstock	WEIGHT ▶	Unconfirmed — comparable Widows run 9 lb 11 oz to 10 lb 0 oz
SCALE / RADIUS	24.75" - 12" - 1.687" Corian nut	CASE / PAPERS	Gibson Custom OHSC, COA, hang tags, warranty card

04 What the market says

Read "listed" (the asking price) and "sold" (what actually changed hands) as two different numbers. For this model the gap is small right now — these hold value unusually well for a modern Gibson because the runs are small and the colour has a cult following.

SOURCE	STATUS	PRICE	NOTES
Guitar Center	LISTED - NEW	\$7,099	"Dark Blue Widow Burst" — current new retail for this exact configuration.
Reverb	SALE - MINT	\$7,199	2024 LP Custom Figured, trans-blue, mint, sold through a dealer. (Nickel-hardware sibling — same family, same year.)
Reverb	LISTED - USED	\$6,500–7,500	Multiple Blue Widow M2M / PSL pieces currently listed by dealers; described as rare & highly desirable.
eBay	SALE	~\$6,750	Closest clean comp is a 2024 Custom Shop (different model). Blue Widow eBay comps are thin; eBay runs softer than Reverb on high-end Gibsons due to ~13% fees.
Boutique dealers	LISTED	\$6,500–7,500	Eddie's, Wildwood, Cream City & similar — where these primarily trade.

The catch: those are *dealer* / *retail* numbers. A private seller does not net retail. After rebate fees (~5%), shipping, and buyers expecting a discount versus a store with a warranty, a private national sale realistically nets somewhere around \$5,200–\$6,200. Selling locally only, in cash, lands lower again — and that's where the Denver-specific math comes in below.

05 What you'd get

SELL TO A DENVER SHOP

Dealer / trade

\$3,800–4,800

CASH OFFER

Shops pay ~50–65% of what they can resell it for. A high-end store that can actually move a Custom Shop piece (e.g. Wildwood in Louisville, or Coal Creek in Englewood, which buys used gear) will sit at the top of that range; a generalist like Guitar Center will lowball a slow-moving blue LP. Expect \$500–\$1,000 more in trade or store credit than in cash.

Instant — same day

LOCAL ONLINE AD - DENVER METRO

Private local

\$4,800–5,500

FACEBOOK / REVERB-LOCAL / CRAIGSLIST

List around \$5,800–\$6,200 to leave room; expect to land in the \$4,800–\$5,500 band with one motivated local buyer. A \$5k+ blue Custom Shop Les Paul is a narrow, high-ticket niche — Denver has the player base, but not many buyers for this guitar at any given moment.

Likely 3–4 months

NATIONAL LISTING

Reverb (best \$)

\$5,200–6,200

NET AFTER FEES & SHIPPING

The widest buyer pool and the only place the colour reliably finds its person. The \$7,199 sold comp shows national demand is real. Price it well and it moves in weeks to ~2 months; the trade-off is packing, shipping a heavy guitar, and fee/return exposure.

Weeks - ~2 months

06 Helps & hurts

+ Adds value	– Caps value
Genuine Nashville Custom Shop — a full tier above Gibson USA; roughly double the resale of a USA Custom. Rare Widow finish with the show-stopping colour-matched binding & headstock inlay — collectible and instantly recognisable. Strong AAA figured top — the flame is dramatic; figure grade directly moves price. Gold hardware & full Custom appointments (ebony board, pearl blocks, multi-ply binding). Complete & correct — OHSC, COA, hang tags, paperwork. Completeness alone is worth several hundred dollars. Near-mint & recent (2024) — modern Custom Shop QC is well regarded.	Polarising colour — blue Les Pauls have a far narrower buyer pool than a 'burst or black. It takes the right buyer, not any buyer. Likely heavy — comparable Widows hit 9.7–10 lb. A 10+ lb weight turns some buyers off; weight it and disclose. 490R/498T pickups are standard Gibson units, not the Historic-grade Custombuckers purists prize. Modern, not vintage/Historic — these depreciate like normal used gear once sold; they don't appreciate like a '59 reissue. Not individually numbered — "rare" but not a numbered limited edition; several are on the market now, which tempers price. Selling friction — fees (Reverb ~5%, eBay ~13%), shipping a heavy guitar, and fee/return exposure would each chip away.

07 If you're unsure — how to verify

Run these checks before you list or sell. Each one either confirms the model or changes the number.

- 01

Custom Shop vs USA. Back of headstock should read "Gibson Custom" and there must be a COA. A plain "Gibson"-only headstock with no certificate is a USA model worth far less.
- 02

Decode the serial. Back of headstock. CS + year-digit + number = Custom Shop. Confirms the build year (here, 2024).
- 03

Confirm it's a Widow. Colour-matched binding *and* a coloured split-diamond inlay = Widow. White/cream binding with a plain pearl inlay = the standard trans-blue variant (often a touch less money).
- 04

Hardware colour. Gold is the premium Widow spec. Nickel 'hand-decorated top' versions also exist and can price slightly differently.
- 05

Identify the pickups. Pop a pickup ring or check the cavity. 490R/498T = standard. Custombuckers add desirability; EMG *actively* narrow the buyer pool. This genuinely moves price.
- 06

Weight it. Put the number in any listing. Under ~9.5 lb helps; 10 lb+ hurts and should be disclosed up front.
- 07

Grade the top. Stronger, more 3-D flame = more money. Photograph it in raking light to show the figure.
- 08

Inspect the headstock & neck. The Achilles heel of Gibsons. Any headstock crack or repair is a major value hit — check the rear (Plate 05) under good light.

FEATURE	VALUE IMPACT (QUICK REFERENCE)	WHY IT MATTERS
Custom Shop vs USA	▲ Major	The single biggest lever — Custom Shop roughly doubles a comparable USA Custom.
Widow matched binding	▲ Helps	Collectible & distinctive — but ties value to the niche colour market.
Gold hardware	▲ Helps	Premium appointments; expected on the top-spec Widow.
Custom-grade pickups	▲ Helps	Historic-grade pickups raise desirability vs 490R/498T.
EMG active pickups	▼ Harms	Great for metal, but shrinks the traditional-buyer pool.
Weight 10 lb+	▼ Harms	Comfort matters; heavy examples are a harder sell.
Blue / non-standard colour	▼ Harms	Fewer buyers than a 'burst/black; lower sale, occasional premium from the right one.
Missing COA or case	▼ Harms	Drops a Custom Shop piece several hundred dollars; completeness is prized.
Headstock / neck repair	▼ Major	The biggest single deduction on any Gibson.
Top figure grade	± Savings	Stronger AAA flame > plain top; varies piece to piece.

08 The listing

One copy-ready title and description that works on Reverb, eBay, Facebook Marketplace and Craigslist. Fill the two blanks (weight, and your call on trades), then trim the bracketed shipping line for the local-pickup-only platforms.

COPY-READY LISTING

DENVER METRO • CO

TITLE

2024 Gibson Custom Shop Les Paul Custom Figured – Dark Blue Widow Burst, OHSC

76 / 80 characters - within eBay's title limit - keywords front-loaded for search

DESCRIPTION

2024 Gibson Custom Shop Les Paul Custom Figured in the rare "Dark Blue Widow Burst" finish — a genuine Nashville Custom Shop instrument (serial CS403228), a full tier above the standard Gibson USA line, from the low-volume dealer-exclusive "Widow" run you rarely see come up.

- Hand-picked AAA figured (flame) maple top on a mahogany body.
- Trans-blue "Widow" finish — color-matched blue binding on body, neck & headstock, plus the blue split-diamond headstock inlay
- Full Les Paul Custom appointments: ebony fingerboard, pearl block inlays, multi-ply binding
- Gold hardware throughout — Tone-metric bridge, stopbar, Grover Kidney tuners
- Factory humbuckers (490R/498T) 2 volume / 2 tone 3-way toggle
- 24.75" scale - 12" radius - weight ____ lbs

Condition: near-mint and very lightly played — no breaks, no repairs, no issues. Comes complete with the original Gibson Custom hardshell case, Certificate of Authenticity, hang tags & paperwork.

A genuine head-turner and a serious player's or collector's Custom Shop Les Paul. Priced to sell; reasonable offers considered. Trades: ____

Located in the Denver metro [Englewood / Denver, CO]. Local pickup welcome — cash or verified payment. [Online buyers: shipping available to the lower 48, fully insured & double-boxed.]

FB MARKETPLACE

Local pickup only — delete the shipping line.

Expect lowball offers; mark price "firm" or pad it.

Meet at a police station safe-exchange lot.

CRAIGSLIST

Local pickup, cash — delete the shipping line.

Denver metro; meet in public, daytime.

Use a few photos in post; offer the rest on request.

REVERB

Best reach for this niche colour.

Enable CONUS shipping, insured + double-boxed.

~5% fee; keep the shipping line in.

EBAY

Broadest audience; ~13% fees.

Paid the price slightly to absorb fees.

Ship signature required; keep all packaging.

Suggested ask: \$5,800–6,200 local • \$4,200–6,500 online (CRO)

Confirm weight & pickups before posting

Lead photo: Plate 04 + Plate 01

METHODOLOGY

Identification from submitted photographs and the Gibson Custom Certificate of Authenticity. Valuation triangulated from current dealer retail, completed Reverb sales, eBay completed listings, and active boutique-dealer asking prices for this model and its closest siblings, as of the issue date. Channel estimates apply standard resale spreads (dealers ~50–65% of resale; private national net after ~4% platform fees and shipping).

SOURCES CONSULTED

Gibson Custom — model / spec references
Guitar Center — new retail (Dark Blue Widow Burst)
Reverb — sold & active listings + price guide
eBay — completed-listing comps
Eddie's • Wildwood • Cream City • Sweetwater — dealer asks
Gibson Custom Shop serial-format references

DISCLAIMER

This is an informal market estimate for the owner's planning purposes — not a certified or insurance appraisal. Other value moves with condition, weight, configuration, and demand confirm the fastest firm pickups (weights, headstock condition) before relying on any figure. Visual styling is loosely inspired by Coal Creek Gibsons (Englewood, CO); this document is independent and not affiliated with or issued by any retailer.